MODULE 9

Global Guardians

"The environment is where we all meet... it is the one thing all of us share."

— LADY BIRD JOHNSON

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What can people do to care for our planet?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Luz Sees the Light**	· Claudia Davila	GRAPHIC NOVEL
2	**On Sea Turtle Patrol**	· Nancy Dawson (illus. Denise Ortakales)	REALISTIC FICTION + VIDEO
3	**How Can We Reduce Household Waste?**	· Mary K. Pratt	INFORMATIONAL
4	**Seeds of Change**	· Jen Cullerton Johnson (illus. Sonia Lynn Sadler)	BIOGRAPHY

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A · Vocabulary (25) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 5

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 11

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 14

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 9 · Global Guardians · Grade 4 · 25 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

ecology

Ecology is —

- ◯ **A.** the study of rocks and the layers of the earth.
- ◯ **B.** the relationship between living things and their environment.
- ◯ **C.** the act of clearing land to build new houses.
- ◯ **D.** the weather and temperature of one small place.

Q2 L.4.6

conservation

Conservation is —

- ◯ **A.** the act of using up natural resources as fast as possible.
- ◯ **B.** the act of saving and protecting the environment.
- ◯ **C.** the act of cleaning up trash only after it has been dumped.
- ◯ **D.** the act of moving animals from one zoo to another.

Q3 L.4.6

sanctuary

A **sanctuary** is —

- ◯ **A.** a place where people or animals go to be safe from danger.
- ◯ **B.** a place where animals are hunted and trapped.
- ◯ **C.** a place where land is cleared and paved over.
- ◯ **D.** a place where trash is buried in the ground.

Q4 L.4.6

recycle

If you **recycle** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** bury it deep in the ground forever.
- ◯ **B.** break it so no one can use it.
- ◯ **C.** hide it from everyone.
- ◯ **D.** put it through a process so that it can be reused.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · LUZ SEES THE LIGHT

Q5 L.4.4

frequent

Luz and her friends enjoy **frequent** trips to the mall. If something is **frequent**, it —

- ◯ **A.** happens often.
- ◯ **B.** happens only once in a lifetime.
- ◯ **C.** costs a lot of money.
- ◯ **D.** takes place far away.

Q6 L.4.5 TRAP

sufficient

Luz wants to be more self-**sufficient**. If something is **sufficient**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** far too little to be of any use.
- ◯ **B.** just what is needed and no more.
- ◯ **C.** much more than anyone could ever use.
- ◯ **D.** broken and impossible to fix.

Q7 L.4.4

oasis

The new park feels like an **oasis**. An **oasis** is —

- ◯ **A.** a loud and crowded street with no place to rest.
- ◯ **B.** a relaxing or peaceful spot in an area that is unpleasant in some way.
- ◯ **C.** a dry, empty stretch of land where nothing grows.
- ◯ **D.** a bare lot full of weeds and old trash.

Q8 L.4.4

permission

Luz needs **permission** to use the empty lot. If you get **permission**, —

- **A.** you are told to stay away.
- **B.** you are kept from doing it.
- **C.** someone who is in charge allows you to do what you asked to do.
- **D.** you must pay a large fine before you may begin.

Q9 L.4.4

installing

The neighbors begin **installing** garden beds. If you are **installing** something, you are —

- **A.** taking it apart so it can no longer be used.
- **B.** pulling it out and throwing it away.
- **C.** moving it from one place to another to store it.
- **D.** setting it up in place so it is ready to use.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · LUZ SEES THE LIGHT (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.4.5 TRAP

abandoned

Luz turns an **abandoned** lot into a garden. If a place is **abandoned**, it is —

- **A.** carefully cared for every day.
- **B.** full of people all the time.
- **C.** no longer cared for or used.
- **D.** brand new and freshly built.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · ON SEA TURTLE PATROL

Q11 L.4.4

obsessed

Callie becomes **obsessed** with sea turtles. If you are **obsessed** with something, you —

- **A.** never think about it at all.
- **B.** think about it all the time.
- **C.** quickly forget about it.
- **D.** are only a little bit interested in it.

Q12 L.4.5 TRAP

disoriented

Bright lights leave the baby turtles **disoriented**. Creatures that are **disoriented** are —

- ◯ **A.** sure of exactly where they are going.
- ◯ **B.** able to find their way home with ease.
- ◯ **C.** confused about where they are.
- ◯ **D.** headed straight toward the water.

Q13 L.4.5 TRAP

blunt

The tool has a **blunt** tip. Something that is **blunt** is —

- ◯ **A.** pointed and very sharp.
- ◯ **B.** thin and able to cut easily.
- ◯ **C.** flat or rounded, rather than sharp.
- ◯ **D.** jagged with a fine, keen edge.

Q14 L.4.4

recruiting

Gram is **recruiting** new volunteers. If you are **recruiting** people, you are —

- ◯ **A.** sending them all away from the group.
- ◯ **B.** telling them they are no longer needed.
- ◯ **C.** letting them go after the work is done.
- ◯ **D.** asking them to join in and help do something.

Q15 L.4.4

appointed

Callie is **appointed** to record the nests. If you are **appointed** to a job, you are —

- ◯ **A.** assigned to or chosen for it.
- ◯ **B.** told that you may not do it.
- ◯ **C.** passed over for someone else.
- ◯ **D.** asked to leave the team.

Q16 L.4.4

stranded

A turtle is **stranded** on the beach. If you are **stranded**, you are —

- ◯ **A.** resting safely at home.
- ◯ **B.** swimming quickly through the water.
- ◯ **C.** traveling with many friends.
- ◯ **D.** stuck somewhere without a way to leave.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · HOW CAN WE REDUCE HOUSEHOLD WASTE?

Q17 L.4.4

estimate

The number is only an **estimate**. If you give an **estimate**, you give —

- ◯ **A.** the one exact answer, counted with no doubt.
- ◯ **B.** a total that has been measured perfectly.
- ◯ **C.** an amount or size that is not exact.
- ◯ **D.** a count that is always too low.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · HOW CAN WE REDUCE HOUSEHOLD WASTE? (CONTINUED)

Q18 L.4.5 TRAP

decay

Food waste in a landfill begins to **decay**. When things **decay**, they —

- ◯ **A.** slowly break down and rot.
- ◯ **B.** stay fresh and new forever.
- ◯ **C.** grow larger and stronger.
- ◯ **D.** turn hard like stone.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · SEEDS OF CHANGE

Q19 L.4.4

ancestors

Wangari honors her **ancestors**. Your **ancestors** are —

- ◯ **A.** friends you met just this year.
- ◯ **B.** the children in your family who are younger than you.
- ◯ **C.** neighbors who live on your street today.
- ◯ **D.** the people in your family who lived long ago.

Q20 L.4.4

swirled

The leaves **swirled** in the wind. If something **swirled**, it —

- ◯ **A.** lay perfectly still on the ground.
- ◯ **B.** moved quickly around in circles.
- ◯ **C.** sank straight down to the bottom.
- ◯ **D.** drifted slowly in one straight line.

Q21 L.4.4

currents

The river has strong **currents**. **Currents** are —

- ◯ **A.** flowing movements of water in a lake, river, or ocean.
- ◯ **B.** still, calm pools where the water never moves.
- ◯ **C.** tall waves that rise only during a storm.
- ◯ **D.** drops of rain that fall onto the river.

Q22 L.4.5 TRAP

sneered

Some people **sneered** at Wangari's ideas. If you **sneered**, you —

- ◯ **A.** showed kindness and warm respect.
- ◯ **B.** smiled with delight and approval.
- ◯ **C.** cheered the idea on with admiration.
- ◯ **D.** showed disapproval and lack of respect by the look on your face.

Q23 L.4.5 TRAP

outspoken

Wangari grows into an **outspoken** leader. If you are **outspoken**, you —

- ◯ **A.** say what you think even when others do not agree.
- ◯ **B.** only agree with whatever others say.
- ◯ **C.** stay silent and keep your ideas hidden.
- ◯ **D.** speak only in a quiet whisper.

Q24 L.4.4

canopy

Birds rest in the forest **canopy**. A **canopy** is —

- **A.** a rooflike covering, like the top branches of trees in a forest.
- **B.** the bare roots that spread under the forest floor.
- **C.** the rough bark that wraps around a tree trunk.
- **D.** a wide clearing where no trees grow at all.

Q25 L.4.5 TRAP

envision

Wangari can **envision** a greener Kenya. If you **envision** something, you —

- **A.** forget that it ever existed.
- **B.** doubt that it could ever be real.
- **C.** picture it clearly in your mind.
- **D.** put it out of your thoughts completely.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 9 · Global Guardians · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.5 · RL.4.6 · RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3 · RI.4.5 · RI.4.6 · RI.4.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Luz Sees the Light

GRAPHIC NOVEL · CLAUDIA DAVILA · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.4.2

What is "Luz Sees the Light" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A city girl who learns to use less energy and turns an empty lot into a neighborhood park.
- ◯ **B.** A scientist who studies sea turtles on a beach.
- ◯ **C.** A family that opens a new shopping mall.
- ◯ **D.** A girl who travels far away to study at college.

Q2 RL.4.3

At the start of the story, what do Luz and her friends most enjoy?

- ◯ **A.** Planting trees in a community garden.
- ◯ **B.** Listening to music and taking frequent trips to the mall.
- ◯ **C.** Cleaning up a beach early in the morning.
- ◯ **D.** Reading about famous gardeners.

Q3 RL.4.3

What event causes Luz to start thinking about how she uses energy?

- ◯ **A.** She wins a prize at school.
- ◯ **B.** Blackouts dim her neighborhood, and she cannot do some of her favorite activities.
- ◯ **C.** She moves to a new city.
- ◯ **D.** She finds a turtle nest near her home.

Q4 RL.4.3

What does Luz's neighbor Gord say people should do to prepare for more blackouts?

- ◯ **A.** Become more self-sufficient.
- ◯ **B.** Buy more things at the mall.
- ◯ **C.** Wait for someone else to fix the problem.
- ◯ **D.** Move away from the city for good.

Q5 RL.4.3

How does Luz's mother help Luz understand why energy matters?

- ◯ **A.** She tells Luz to stop going to school.
- ◯ **B.** She buys Luz a brand-new car.
- ◯ **C.** She takes Luz on a trip to the beach.
- ◯ **D.** She points out how rising gas prices affect the things Luz cares about, like trips to the mall and groceries.

Q6 RL.4.3

When Luz asks for help with the garden project, how do her friends Robert and Anika respond?

- ◯ **A.** They refuse and walk away.
- ◯ **B.** They agree to help, and Robert says, "What are friends for?"
- ◯ **C.** They move to another town.
- ◯ **D.** They tell her the idea will never work.

Q7 RL.4.6

"Luz Sees the Light" is a graphic novel. How is the story mostly told?

- ◯ **A.** Through a long list of facts and numbers.
- ◯ **B.** Through a letter from one person to another.
- ◯ **C.** Through illustrated panels and speech bubbles.
- ◯ **D.** Through a poem that rhymes on every line.

Q8 RL.4.2

Which sentence best states a THEME of "Luz Sees the Light"?

- ◯ **A.** Shopping at the mall is the best way to spend a weekend.
- ◯ **B.** Blackouts always happen in big cities.
- ◯ **C.** Only adults can solve problems in a neighborhood.
- ◯ **D.** Small choices about energy, and working together, can make a positive difference for a community.

Selection 2 · On Sea Turtle Patrol

REALISTIC FICTION + INFORMATIONAL VIDEO · NANCY DAWSON · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.4.2

What is "On Sea Turtle Patrol" mostly about?

- **A.** A boy who learns to cook in a restaurant.
- **B.** A scientist who studies forests in Kenya.
- **C.** A family that builds a garden in a city lot.
- **D.** A girl who spends her summer volunteering to protect sea turtles on a Florida beach.

Q10 RL.4.3

Who is the narrator of the story, and where is she from?

- **A.** Gram, who has always lived in Florida.
- **B.** Callie, a twelve-year-old city kid from Cincinnati staying with her grandmother.
- **C.** A park ranger who works on the beach.
- **D.** A scientist visiting from another country.

Q11 RL.4.3

Why does Callie have to get up so early each day?

- **A.** She has to go to school.
- **B.** She has to drive into the city.
- **C.** Tracking sea turtles means going out at the start of the day to look for fresh nests.
- **D.** She wants to watch the sunrise for fun.

Q12 RL.4.1

What do the patrol volunteers look for as they walk along the water's edge?

- **A.** Lost beach toys.
- **B.** Fresh turtle tracks, which scientists call "crawls."
- **C.** Boats far out on the ocean.
- **D.** Empty seashells to collect.

Q13 RI.4.3

According to the paired video, why do some kinds of sea turtles need protection and help from humans?

- **A.** Some species are endangered and could become extinct without protection.
- **B.** They eat too much food in the ocean.
- **C.** They swim too quickly for boats.
- **D.** They live only in city ponds.

Q14 RI.4.6

The video "Saving the Kemp's Ridley Sea Turtle" comes from Texas Parks and Wildlife. What is its main purpose?

- ◯ **A.** To sell tickets to a beach.
- ◯ **B.** To give facts and information about protecting an endangered sea turtle.
- ◯ **C.** To tell a make-believe story about a talking turtle.
- ◯ **D.** To teach people how to swim.

Q15 RI.4.5

An informational video like the paired video can do something a print story cannot. What is it?

- ◯ **A.** Use only a table of contents.
- ◯ **B.** Print page numbers at the bottom.
- ◯ **C.** Leave blank lines for the reader to write on.
- ◯ **D.** Show moving clips of real animals in the wild to illustrate the topic.

Q16 RL.4.2

What is one main message of "On Sea Turtle Patrol" and its paired video?

- ◯ **A.** Sea turtles are too hard to help.
- ◯ **B.** Only adult scientists can study animals.
- ◯ **C.** Even kids can help protect endangered sea turtles and care for the environment.
- ◯ **D.** Beaches should be closed to all people.

Selection 3 · How Can We Reduce Household Waste?

INFORMATIONAL / ARGUMENTATIVE TEXT · MARY K. PRATT · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.4.2

What is "How Can We Reduce Household Waste?" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How much trash households create and how people can reduce, reuse, and recycle it.
- ◯ **B.** How to build a sandcastle on the beach.
- ◯ **C.** A made-up story about a talking landfill.
- ◯ **D.** How honeybees make honey.

Q18 RI.4.3

According to the text, about how much trash does the average person in the United States throw away each day?

- **A.** About 4.5 pounds.
- **B.** About one ounce.
- **C.** About 100 pounds.
- **D.** None at all.

Q19 RI.4.3

According to the text, which of these is one of the four basic categories of household waste?

- **A.** Rainwater.
- **B.** Sunlight.
- **C.** E-waste, or electronic waste.
- **D.** Fresh air.

Q20 RI.4.8

The author argues that people should reduce waste. Which reason in the text supports this argument?

- **A.** Trash is colorful and interesting to look at.
- **B.** Landfills are a fun place to visit.
- **C.** Throwing things away saves money for everyone.
- **D.** Recycling and reusing waste keeps materials out of landfills and helps the environment.

Q21 RI.4.5

The author uses headings and subheadings, such as "Types of Household Waste." How do these features help the reader?

- **A.** They give the price of each item.
- **B.** They list the names of the author's friends.
- **C.** They tell the reader what each part of the text will be about.
- **D.** They tell a story about a character.

Q22 RI.4.5

Why does the author organize much of the text by stating a problem and then explaining solutions?

- **A.** To compare two faraway cities.
- **B.** To tell a funny joke.
- **C.** To show readers the problem of too much waste and what can be done about it.
- **D.** To list the steps of a science experiment.

Q23 RI.4.6

What is the author's main purpose for writing this text?

- **A.** To inform readers about household waste and convince them to help reduce it.
- **B.** To sell trash bags to readers.
- **C.** To make readers laugh with silly stories.
- **D.** To describe the author's own childhood.

Q24 RI.4.2

Which sentence best states the CENTRAL IDEA of the text?

- **A.** Only large factories create household waste, so families have nothing they can do about it.
- **B.** Landfills are the best place for all trash, and burying waste is better than recycling it.
- **C.** Americans create a great deal of household waste, but people can reduce it by reducing, reusing, recycling, and composting.
- **D.** Recycling is too hard for most families to do, so it is not really worth the effort to try.

Selection 4 · Seeds of Change

BIOGRAPHY · JEN CULLERTON JOHNSON (ILLUS. SONIA LYNN SADLER) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "Seeds of Change" mostly about?

- **A.** A girl who volunteers on sea turtle patrol.
- **B.** A boy who wins a cooking contest.
- **C.** The life of Wangari Maathai, who grows up in Kenya and works to protect the environment.
- **D.** A family that reduces its household waste.

Q26 RL.4.3

At the beginning of the biography, what does Wangari's mother teach her at the mugumo tree?

- **A.** How to climb to the very top of it.
- **B.** How to cut the tree down for firewood.
- **C.** To ignore the tree and walk past it.
- **D.** To feel and revere the tree, which is home to many and feeds many.

Q27 RL.4.3

What kind of student is Wangari as she grows up?

- **A.** A student who dislikes learning.
- **B.** An excellent student and hard worker who studies science.
- **C.** A student who never goes to school.
- **D.** A student who only studies music.

Q28 RL.4.3

What does Wangari's mother remind her as she leaves to study?

- **A.** That she should never come home again.
- **B.** That science is not important.
- **C.** That she must forget her village.
- **D.** That wherever she goes, she carries her family and village with her.

Q29 RL.4.5

"Seeds of Change" is a biography. How does the author organize the events of Wangari's life?

- **A.** As a list of recipes.
- **B.** As a set of numbered how-to steps.
- **C.** Backward, from the end to the beginning.
- **D.** In chronological order, from her childhood onward.

Q30 RL.4.6

A biography is the story of a real person's life written by someone else. Which detail shows that "Seeds of Change" is a biography, not an autobiography?

- **A.** The author uses third-person words such as *she*, *her*, and *they* to tell about Wangari.
- **B.** Wangari tells the story herself using the word "I."
- **C.** The story is completely made up.
- **D.** The story has no real person in it.

Q31 RL.4.3

As an adult, how does Wangari act on what she learned to love as a child?

- **A.** She grows up to protect the land and the environment of her country.
- **B.** She decides never to return to Kenya.
- **C.** She moves far away and forgets about trees.
- **D.** She stops caring about nature.

Q32 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the main THEME, or lesson, of "Seeds of Change"?

- ◯ **A.** Wangari's mother shows her a sacred tree called the mugumo when she is a girl.
- ◯ **B.** One determined person, rooted in love of family and the land, can plant "seeds of change" and help protect the natural world.
- ◯ **C.** Wangari is a very good science student who works hard at her studies.
- ◯ **D.** Wangari travels far from her village to the city in order to study.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 9 · Global Guardians · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how people can care for our planet. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Luz Sees the Light,"** Luz changes the way she uses energy and helps her neighborhood. Show WHAT problem Luz notices, then explain HOW she takes responsibility and what it teaches.

TAKING RESPONSIBILITY FOR THE PLANET · LUZ SEES THE LIGHT

THE PROBLEM	WHAT LUZ DOES	WHY IT MATTERS

Luz decides to use less energy and to turn an abandoned lot into a neighborhood park. Why is it powerful when one person takes responsibility for small, everyday choices about energy and their community? Explain.

Q2 Sustainability DOK 3

In **"On Sea Turtle Patrol,"** Callie volunteers to protect endangered sea turtles. Show WHAT the turtles need, then explain HOW protecting them helps care for the planet.

PROTECTING LIVING THINGS · ON SEA TURTLE PATROL

WHAT TURTLES NEED	HOW PEOPLE HELP	WHY IT LASTS
what does the text say?	*what do Callie and Gram do?*	*why protect a species?*

The text and the video show that some sea turtles are endangered. Why does protecting one kind of animal help keep the whole environment healthy for the future? Explain.

Q3 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"How Can We Reduce Household Waste?,"** the author argues that people make too much waste. Compare the PROBLEM with a SOLUTION, then explain the lesson.

PROBLEM AND SOLUTION · HOUSEHOLD WASTE

THE PROBLEM	A SOLUTION

The author says Americans throw away about 4.5 pounds of waste per person each day. Why is it important for each person to take responsibility for reducing, reusing, and recycling waste? Explain.

Q4 Change DOK 3

In **"Seeds of Change,"** Wangari Maathai grows from a girl who loves a sacred tree into a leader who protects the land. Show the CHANGE in Wangari, then explain the lesson it teaches.

PLANTING SEEDS OF CHANGE · SEEDS OF CHANGE

WANGARI AS A GIRL	WANGARI AS A LEADER

Wangari's love of the land as a child grew into action that helped protect the environment of a whole country. Why can one person's care for nature plant "seeds of change"? Use the word *change* in your answer.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: What can people do to care for our planet? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What does this selection teach about caring for the planet?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What does this selection teach about caring for the planet?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 9 · Global Guardians · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Park on Maple Street

For years, the empty lot on Maple Street was full of weeds and old trash. No one took care of it. Cans and broken glass lay in the tall grass, and the children who lived nearby had nowhere to play. One spring, a girl named Rosa had an idea. "We could turn this lot into a park," she said. At first, her friends laughed. But Rosa did not give up. She asked the city for permission to use the land. Then she asked her neighbors to help. On a sunny Saturday, families came with rakes, shovels, and gloves. They cleared away the trash and pulled up the weeds. They planted small trees and bright flowers. Some neighbors built wooden benches. The children painted a sign that said "Maple Street Park." By summer, the ugly lot had become a green and shady place. Birds came to the new trees. Families gathered to talk and rest. The park did not cost much money, but it changed the whole street. Rosa learned that when neighbors work together, even a small piece of land can become something good for everyone.

186 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 · Lexile 500L · Key Detail

At the beginning, what is the empty lot on Maple Street like?

- ◯ **A.** It is a clean, green park.
- ◯ **B.** It is covered by a large house.
- ◯ **C.** It is full of weeds and old trash.
- ◯ **D.** It is a busy parking lot.

Q2 RIT 202 · Lexile 520L · Key Detail

What does Rosa ask the city for before starting?

- ◯ **A.** A large sum of money.
- ◯ **B.** A new school.
- ◯ **C.** A truck full of trash.
- ◯ **D.** Permission to use the land.

Q3 RIT 203 · Lexile 530L · Cause & Effect

Why does the lot finally change into a park?

- ◯ **A.** The city builds it with machines.
- ◯ **B.** The weeds turn into flowers by themselves.
- ◯ **C.** Rosa and her neighbors work together to clear it and plant trees.
- ◯ **D.** A storm washes away the trash.

Q4 RIT 205 · Lexile 550L · Cause & Effect

What happens after the new trees are planted?

- ◯ **A.** Birds come to the trees, and families gather to talk and rest.
- ◯ **B.** The park is closed to children.
- ◯ **C.** The weeds grow back taller.
- ◯ **D.** The trees are cut down.

Q5 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Main Idea

What is this passage MOSTLY about?

- ◯ **A.** How neighbors working together can turn an empty lot into a park for everyone.
- ◯ **B.** How to paint a wooden sign.
- ◯ **C.** Why birds build nests in the spring.
- ◯ **D.** How a city sells empty land.

Passage 2 · The Lighthouse and the Turtles

Every summer, sea turtles crawl onto the warm sand to lay their eggs. Weeks later, tiny baby turtles hatch at night. For a long time, the little turtles knew exactly where to go. They followed the bright moonlight that shone on the ocean, and the moon led them safely to the water. But near one beach stood a town with many lights. Streetlights, porch lights, and store signs glowed all night long. When the baby turtles hatched, they grew confused. The town lights were brighter than the moon. Instead of crawling toward the sea, many turtles crawled the wrong way, toward the roads. There they were in danger. A group of neighbors decided to help. They asked the town to turn off bright lights near the beach during hatching season. Some people put special covers on their porch lights so the light pointed down, not out toward the sand. They even painted a few windows dark. The next summer, the beach was quiet and dim at night. When the baby turtles hatched, they followed the moon once more and reached the water safely. A small change in the town's lights had saved many young turtles.

195 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

For a long time, what led the baby turtles safely to the water?

- **A.** A loud bell on a boat.
- **B.** The bright moonlight on the ocean.
- **C.** A map drawn in the sand.
- **D.** The store signs in the town.

Q7 RIT 208 · Lexile 580L · Cause & Effect

Why do many baby turtles crawl the wrong way, toward the roads?

- **A.** They are looking for food.
- **B.** They are following other turtles.
- **C.** The sand is too hot to cross.
- **D.** The town lights are brighter than the moon, and the turtles grow confused.

Q8 RIT 209 · Lexile 590L · Key Detail

What is one thing the neighbors do to help the turtles?

- **A.** They carry every turtle to the water by hand.
- **B.** They build a tall wall on the beach.
- **C.** They add more streetlights near the sand.
- **D.** They ask the town to turn off bright lights near the beach during hatching season.

Q9 RIT 210 · Lexile 600L · Inference

Why is the beach "quiet and dim at night" the next summer?

- **A.** A storm knocked out all the power.
- **B.** The neighbors changed the town's lights to help the turtles.
- **C.** Everyone moved away from the town.
- **D.** The moon stopped shining.

Q10 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Main Idea

What is the main lesson of "The Lighthouse and the Turtles"?

- **A.** Bright lights make a town look pretty.
- **B.** A small change by people who care can protect young sea turtles.
- **C.** Turtles can see better than people.
- **D.** The moon is brighter than any light.

Passage 3 · How a Plastic Bottle Is Recycled

Have you ever wondered what happens to a plastic bottle after you drop it into a recycling bin? Its journey is just beginning. First, a truck carries the bottle to a recycling center. There, machines and workers sort the trash. They separate plastic from paper, metal, and glass, because each material is recycled in a different way. Next, the plastic bottles are cleaned to remove any leftover liquid or dirt. After they are clean, the bottles are crushed and chopped into tiny flakes. These plastic flakes are no bigger than a fingernail. Then the flakes are washed again and dried. At a factory, the flakes are heated until they melt into a soft, stretchy material. The melted plastic can be pulled into long, thin threads. Believe it or not, those threads can be spun into yarn and woven into cloth. The cloth is used to make new things, such as warm jackets, backpacks, and even carpets. So one old water bottle might one day become part of a soft fleece jacket. Recycling turns something we throw away into something useful again, and it keeps plastic out of landfills and oceans.

190 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

What is the FIRST thing that happens to the bottle after it goes into the bin?

- ◯ **A.** A truck carries it to a recycling center.
- ◯ **B.** It is woven into cloth.
- ◯ **C.** It is melted into thread.
- ◯ **D.** It is buried in a landfill.

Q12 RIT 212 · Lexile 640L · Cause & Effect

Why are the plastic bottles sorted away from paper, metal, and glass?

- ◯ **A.** Because each material is recycled in a different way.
- ◯ **B.** Because the other materials are thrown away.
- ◯ **C.** Because only plastic can be recycled.
- ◯ **D.** Because plastic is the heaviest material.

Q13 RIT 213 · Lexile 660L · Key Detail

What are the plastic bottles turned into after they are crushed?

- ◯ **A.** Large glass jars.
- ◯ **B.** Tiny flakes no bigger than a fingernail.
- ◯ **C.** Sheets of paper.
- ◯ **D.** Metal cans.

Q14 RIT 215 · Lexile 680L · Vocabulary

The passage says the flakes are heated until they "melt" into a soft material. In this sentence, **melt** means —

- ◯ **A.** freeze into hard ice.
- ◯ **B.** break into sharp pieces.
- ◯ **C.** float on top of water.
- ◯ **D.** turn soft and liquid from heat.

Q15 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "How a Plastic Bottle Is Recycled"?

- ◯ **A.** Plastic bottles are sold in stores.
- ◯ **B.** Trucks carry trash every day.
- ◯ **C.** Recycling turns something we throw away into something useful and keeps plastic out of landfills and oceans.
- ◯ **D.** Jackets are warmer than carpets.

Passage 4 · The Girl Who Planted a Forest

Long ago, in a green valley, there lived a girl named Amara who loved the trees. Her grandmother had told her that the trees were a gift, for they gave shade, fruit, and homes for birds. But as Amara grew older, she watched the trees of the valley disappear. People cut them down for firewood and to clear land. Year by year, the hills turned brown and bare. When the rains came, there were no roots to hold the soil, and the good earth washed away. The streams grew muddy, and the birds flew off to find new homes. Amara was sad, but she was not silent. "If people can cut down a forest," she said, "then people can grow one back." She began with a single seed. She dug a small hole, planted it, and watered it each day. Her neighbors sneered at first, but Amara kept planting. Slowly, others joined her. Children, parents, and grandparents all planted young trees on the bare hills. The years passed. The little trees grew tall, and their leaves formed a green canopy over the valley once more. Birds returned, the soil stayed in place, and the streams ran clear. One girl with one seed had helped a whole forest — and a whole village — come back to life.

215 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Key Detail

According to Amara's grandmother, why are the trees a gift?

- ◯ **A.** They can be sold for gold.
- ◯ **B.** They are easy to cut down.
- ◯ **C.** They give shade, fruit, and homes for birds.
- ◯ **D.** They block the road into town.

Q17 RIT 217 · Lexile 720L · Cause & Effect

What happens to the valley after the people cut down most of the trees?

- ◯ **A.** The hills turn brown and bare, and the good soil washes away in the rain.
- ◯ **B.** The valley fills with new birds.
- ◯ **C.** The streams run clear and clean.
- ◯ **D.** More trees grow on their own.

Q18 RIT 218 Lexile 740L Key Detail

How does Amara begin to bring the forest back?

- **A.** She asks the king for help.
- **B.** She builds a wall around the hills.
- **C.** She plants a single seed and waters it each day.
- **D.** She moves to a new valley.

Q19 RIT 219 Lexile 770L Vocabulary

The story says Amara's neighbors "sneered at first." The word **sneered** means they —

- **A.** cheered for her loudly.
- **B.** showed scorn and did not respect her idea.
- **C.** helped her right away.
- **D.** fell fast asleep.

Q20 RIT 220 Lexile 800L Main Idea

What is the lesson, or theme, of this story?

- **A.** Birds like to live in tall trees.
- **B.** Rain can wash away soil.
- **C.** Firewood comes from trees.
- **D.** One determined person can plant "seeds of change" and help heal the land for everyone.